



Quality of Parent-Child Interactions in Migrant Community

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Purpose

- Parents are an essential scaffolding system for their children’s development and education in early childhood
- The rapid political transition and associated economic collapse in transitional countries, such as Kyrgyz Republic, led children and their families to be suffered from family structure changes and altered parenting practices caused by decreased childcare facilities and social support
- The purpose of this study was to assess the quality of parent-child interactions in Kyrgyz Rep. by analyzing the interaction patterns and playfulness of children during free play at home.

Methods

- Descriptive study using video-recorded
- Instrument
 - ✓ Dyadic Parent-Child Interaction Coding System
 - ✓ Playfulness
- Data collection: July 2017
- Participants
 - ✓ 21 dyads of parents and their children living in migrant communities of Kyrgyz Rep.
 - ✓ 20 mothers and one father
 - ✓ Average age of 31.57 (±7.02) years
 - ✓ 66.7% with secondary education
 - ✓ Families occupation: business, unskilled labor, professional work, weaving, and others
 - ✓ 12(57.1%) male and 9 (42.8 %) female children
 - ✓ Average age of child participants: 22.4 (±8.68) months.

Results

- Major parent-child interaction patterns included 461 turns of parent-child dyads during 805 episodes.
- Direct command (24.6%) was the most frequently used parent behavior in this study, followed by indirect command (24.2%) Labeled praise (0.61%) was the least used behavior in the interaction. Children frequently used compliance as well as noncompliance when they interacted with their parents
- Children had low playfulness scores while interacting with their parents. Cognitive spontaneity was the component with the lowest score among all subdomains of playfulness.

Table 1. Parent interaction in parent-child dyads

Factors of interaction	N	%
Direct Command	199	26.5%
Indirect Command	196	26.1%
Neutral Talk	171	22.78%
Positive Touch	46	6.13%
Information Question	42	5.59%
Behavioral Description	28	3.73%
Descriptive/Reflective Question	23	3.06%
Reflective Statement	16	2.13%
Negative talk	14	1.86%
Unlabeled Praise	11	1.46%
Labeled Praise	5	0.67%

Reference

- Bühler-Niederberger, D, & Schwittek, J.(2014). Young children in Kyrgyzstan: Agency in tight hierarchical structures. *Childhood*, 21(4), 502-516
- Barnett, L.A. (1990). Playfulness: Definition, design and measurement. *Play & Culture*, 3, 319-336.

Table 2. Child interaction behaviors in parent-child dyads

Factors of interaction	N	%
Compliance	191	38.66%
Noncompliance	101	20.45%
Questions	45	9.11%
Yell	23	4.66%
Answer	23	4.66%
Whine	20	4.05%
Commands	18	3.64%
Negative talk	16	3.24%
No Answer	15	3.04%
Positive Touch	14	2.83%
Prosocial Talk	10	2.02%
Negative touch	8	1.62%
No opportunity for compliance	6	1.21%
No opportunity for Answer	4	0.81%

Conclusion

- Deficiencies and limitations in parenting practices resulted in poor parent-child interaction mostly in underserved areas
- Nurturing environment and stimulation are critical for improved child developmental outcomes, and that parents are a critical scaffolding system for child development, more strategies are needed to facilitate parents’ active interaction and play with their children
- Future studies are recommended to develop strategies to facilitate parents’ active interaction with their children, promote children’s playfulness, and improve the quality of their mutual interaction.

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